Back Disability Mini -DBQ (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

Answer the following regarding the current severity of your Service-Connected (s/c) back condition. Please mark the condition(s) you are diagnosed with:

- ☐ Mechanical Back Pain Syndrome
- ☐ Facet joint arthropathy (degenerative joint disease of lumbosacral spine)
- ☐ Degenerative Scoliosis
- ☐ Degenerative Spondylolisthesis
- ☐ Radiculopathy
- ☐ Ankylosing spondylitis of thoracolumbar spine (back)
- ☐ Vertebral Fracture
- ☐ Lumbosacral sprain/strain
- ☐ Degenerative disc disease
- ☐ Foramina/lateral recess/central stenosis
- ☐ Spondylosis/isthmic spondylolisthesis
- ☐ Ankylosis of thoracolumbar spine
- ☐ Intervertebral disc syndrome
- ☐ Other (specify)

Please answer the following conditions related to your condition:

When were you first diagnosed with this condition?

What caused the condition (during your service)? Did it get worse with time?

Do you experience flare-ups (worsening of the features associated with the disease e.g. pain weakness etc)?

☐ Yes ☐ No

How do the flare-ups affect your condition (i.e. increased weakness, fatigue, pain etc)?

How do the flare-ups affect your daily life/work (i.e. limited movement, pain, difficulty in lifting weights etc)?

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CHECK OFF THE CONTRIBUTING FACTORS THAT AFFECT THE FUNCTIONALITY OF YOUR BACK:

☐ Muscle spasms	☐ Swelling/Tenderness
☐ Weakened movement	☐ More movement than normal
☐ Easily fatigued (tired)	☐ Less movement than normal
☐ Interferes with standing	☐ Pain on movement
☐ Interferes with sitting	☐ Incoordination*
☐ Affects your walking motion	☐ Guarding (protecting back to avoid flares)

*Incoordination is the impaired ability to execute skilled motions smoothly.

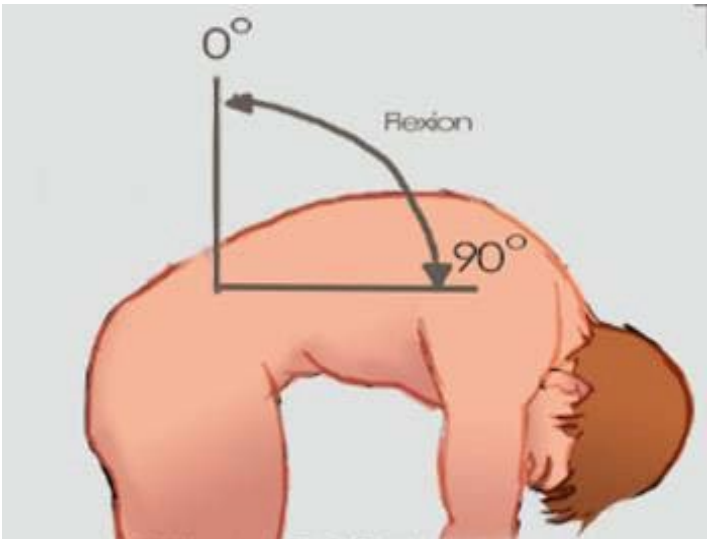
History of Back Surgery – Provide type of surgery and date (month, year):

Dominant Hand		
☐ Right Hand	☐ Left Hand	☐ Ambidextrous

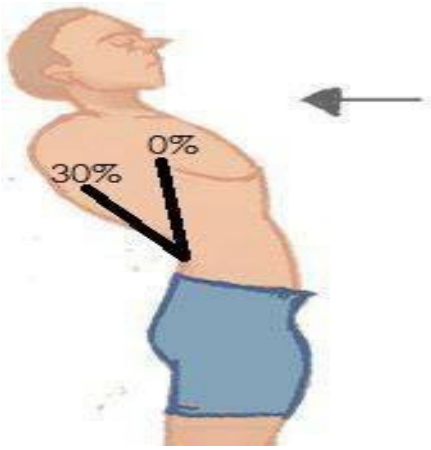
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RANGE OF MOTION: This determines your VA disability rating

FORWARD FLEXION Begin by standing. Bend forward as shown in
Initial Forward Flexion
To which degree can you bend forward? (90 degrees are full range of motion)
Flare-Up Forward Flexion: Think about when your back is HURTING.
How far can you bend forward during a FLARE UP (only if applicable)?

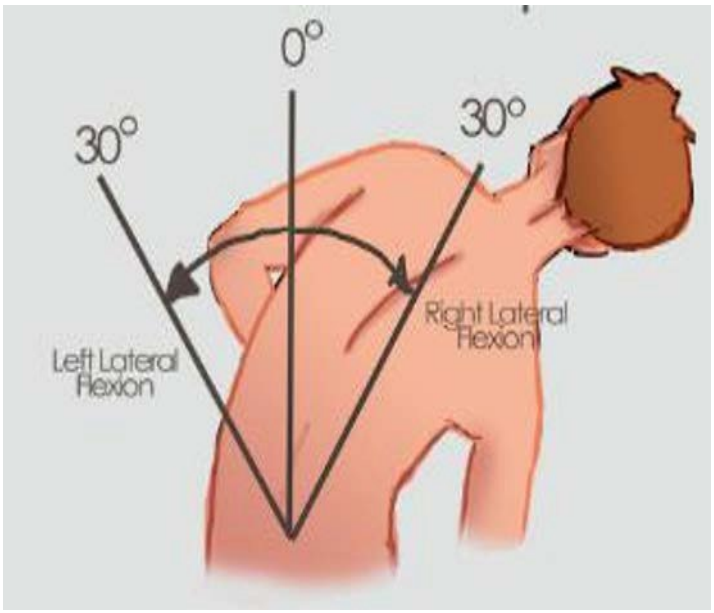


EXTENSION Begin by standing. Bend backwards as shown in
Initial Extension
To which degree can you bend backwards? (30 degrees is full range of motion)
Flare-Up Extension: Think about when your back is HURTING.
How far can you bend back during a FLARE-UP (only if applicable)?

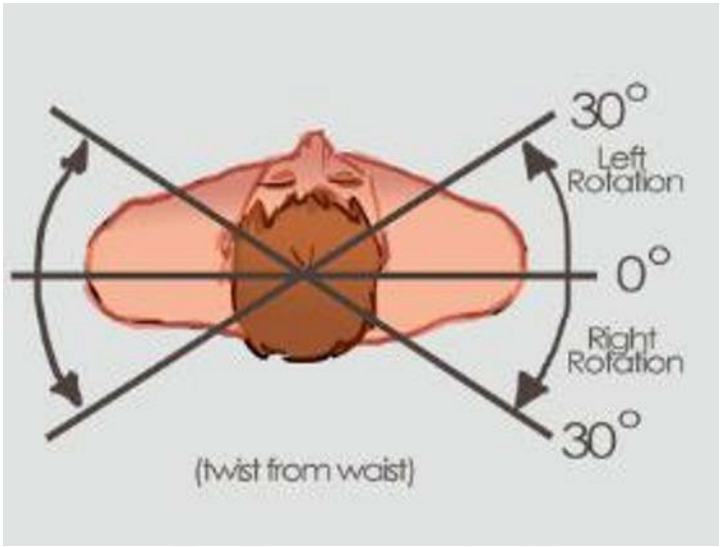


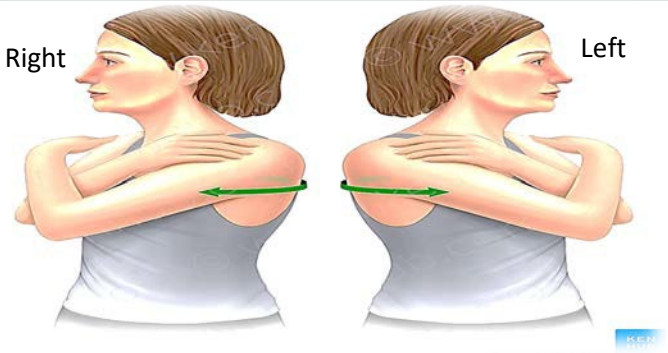
Back Disability Mini -DBQ (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

LATERAL FLEXION Begin by standing. Bend to both sides as shown in picture to the right	
Initial Lateral Flexion	
To which degree can you bend left & right? (30 degrees are full range of motion)	
Left	Right
Flare-Up Lateral Flexion: Think about when your back is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above.	
How far can you bend left & right during a FLARE UP? (30 degrees are full range of motion)	
Left	Right



LATERAL ROTATION Begin by standing. Twist from waist to the left and	
Initial Lateral Rotation	
To which degree can you twist to both sides? (30 degrees are full range of motion).	
Left	Right
Flare-Up Lateral Flexion: Think about when your back is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above.	
How far can you twist to both sides during a FLARE up?	
Left	Right





Can you perform repetitive-use testing of all the movements mentioned above? If so, do you experience any additional limitation of range of movement?

Do you have any localized tenderness/swelling or pain on palpation (touching) of joints or the back area? If yes, describe including location and severity:

Do you have guarding (involuntary stiffness or tensing of muscles due to pain) or muscle spasm of the back?

Do you have any scars related to your back condition? If so are the scars painful?

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RADICULOPATHY - Also known as NERVE ISSUESand/or RADIATING PAIN DOWN LEGS)
Symptoms of radiculopathy are very common with back disabilities, and you may be eligible for additional ratings

Common symptoms:

- *sharp **pain** starting in the back, extending to thefoot.*
- *sharp **pain** with sitting or coughing.*
- ***numbness** or weakness in the leg and foot.*
- ***numbness** or **tingling** in the back or leg.*

Mild symptoms: doesn't really interfere with activities of daily living (ADLs), only minor issues
Moderatesymptoms: does affect ADLs; more constant and painful and/or weakened movement

Do you ever experience ANY symptoms at ANY time of radiculopathy?

Yes, **MILD** symptoms		
☐ Right Leg	☐ Left Leg	☐ Both Legs

Yes, **MODERATE** symptoms		
☐ Right Leg	☐ Left Leg	☐ Both Legs

Check all the symptom(s) of radiculopathy that apply and mention their frequency of occurrence:

☐ No, I do not have radiculopathy symptoms

Constant Pain:
☐ Right Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
☐ Left Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

Intermittent Pain:
☐ Right Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
☐ Left Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

Dull Pain:
☐ Right Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
☐ Left Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

Paranesthesia's and/or Dysesthesias (tingling sensation):
☐ Right Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
☐ Left Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

Numbness:
☐ Right Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
☐ Left Lower Extremity: ☐ None ☐ Mild ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

Additional symptoms.

CERTIFICATION - To the best of my knowledge, the information contained herein is accurate, complete and current. I understand that overstating the severity of my conditions on official Disability Benefits Questionnaires (DBQs) could result in loss of benefits and/or be consider fraudulent. I am conveying the severity of my symptoms to the best of my ability on this personal assessment form. No one has advised me to misrepresent my conditions or overstate the severity of my symptoms.